

DIGITALKARTAI

This kit is written for one person: a final-year student in an Indian engineering college whose placement season has either just started or is about to. Maybe you are in a Tier-2 or Tier-3 college where the mass recruiters arrive between September and December. Maybe you missed the August drives and the next notice is already on the Training & Placement board. Either way, the next 60 days decide a disproportionate share of your career options, and this kit compresses everything that matters into one place.

Read Parts 1 and 2 today. They are short, and they prevent the errors that cost students whole companies before a single question is asked. Then work Parts 3 to 8 in order as the season unfolds. Every company pattern, salary band and eligibility rule in this kit was verified in September 2026 against official hiring pages and recent candidate reports — and wherever a number is a candidate-reported rather than official, published, the kit says so, and tells you to confirm it on your own drive notice.

THE CAMPUS

THE ONE RULE THAT RUNS THE WHOLE SEASON

Prepare in sequence, not all at once. Aptitude and resume first (they gate everything), core CS and coding second, spoken answers last. The students who fail are usually not the ones who know less — they are the ones who prepared everything shallowly and simultaneously.

The fresher's field guide to India's IT placement season — every big recruiter's test decoded, the interviews that follow, and the offer letter finally explained in plain language.

- TCS NQT · Infosys · Wipro · Accenture · Cognizant GenC — 2026-27 patterns
- Eligibility rules, aptitude engine, resume, GD, technical & HR rounds
- CTC vs in-hand decoded, the 30-day sprint plan, drive-day checklists
- Verified against official hiring pages and candidate reports, September 2026

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Eight parts. One complete placement-season system.

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Part 7 — Decode the Offer Letter

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Part 8 — The 30-Day Sprint Plan

A week-by-week, day-shaped plan plus the drive-day protocol and final checklists.

A NOTE ON NUMBERS

Test patterns and salary bands are verified as of September 2026. Companies tweak sections between cycles, and campus drives can differ from off-campus ones. Your campus drive notice always beats any guide — including this one. Where a figure is candidate-reported, treat it as a practice target, not a promise.

PART 1

How the Season Actually Works

The structure nobody explains until it is too late.

IN THIS PART

The six-stage funnel every company runs, and where candidates actually get eliminated

The placement calendar: who arrives in August, who arrives by December

Why 'preparing as the season goes' leaves you weakest when it matters most

What your Training & Placement cell controls — and what it does not

The funnel every drive runs through

Almost every campus placement process in Indian IT follows the same six stages. The pre-placement talk (PPT) → registration or nomination through your college → the online test → technical interview(s) → HR round → offer. A few things inside that funnel are learned the hard way:

The online test eliminates more candidates than all the interview rounds combined.

Service companies filter 50–70% of applicants at the aptitude/online assessment stage. A brilliant coder who fails the aptitude cutoff never gets to show the coding.

The best companies usually come first. Placement calendars are broadly stacked by package: the highest-paying product companies and top consulting firms recruit in the opening weeks, mass recruiters run through the middle of the season, and the calendar thins toward December. Preparing 'as the season goes' means being at your weakest exactly when the strongest opportunities visit.

Communication is the hidden filter. In 2026-27, many Wipro drives add a spoken-English round, Accenture runs an automated communication assessment, and Cognizant opens with one. A large share of rejections in later rounds come from presentation, not knowledge.

The season calendar

For the 2027 graduating batch, the 2026-27 cycle opened mid-August 2026 at the IITs, NITs and IIITs, and rolls into Tier-2 and Tier-3 colleges from mid-September. Mass recruiters — TCS, Infosys, Wipro, Cognizant, Accenture — run through October and November, and several wrap bulk offers before the year ends. That gives a final-year student roughly a 4-to-10-week realistic window between 'notices on the board' and 'first company arrives', which is why Part 8 of this kit is a 30-day sprint and not a six-month plan.

Window	Who typically visits	What it means for you
Aug - mid Sep	Product companies, top consulting, GCCs (IITs/NITs first)	Highest packages of the season; if your college gets these, be ready from day one
Mid Sep - Oct	Tier-1 services: TCS, Infosys, Accenture, Cognizant	The volume wave — this is where most offers are made
Nov - Dec	Wipro, remaining mass recruiters, smaller IT firms	Last big wave; companies that arrive late have fewer seats
Jan - Mar	Late drives, off-campus windows, pool drives	Second chances — keep InfyTQ, NQT scorecards and portal profiles active

What the T&P cell decides

Your Training & Placement cell controls three things that matter enormously: the company list your college can attract, the eligibility list (which students are allowed to sit for which company — backlog and percentage rules are applied here), and the registration paperwork. It does not control your preparation. Build one relationship with the T&P coordinator this month: ask two questions — which companies visited last year in what order, and what eligibility filters they applied. That single conversation gives you a more accurate target list than any online forum.

FIELD NOTE — THE REGISTRATION TRAP

Every season, students discover on registration day that a backlog rule or percentage criterion excludes them from a company they had prepared weeks for. Read criteria first, prepare second. Your drive notice outranks every general guideline, including this kit's.

PART 2

Eligibility: Read the Fine Print First

The cheapest rejections in the entire season happen on paper.

IN THIS PART

The common 60% floor — and the companies that ask for more

Backlogs, gap years and cool-off periods

Registration-day traps: names, PAN, email IDs and one-attempt rules

The documents folder you should build this week

The common floor: 60% or 6.0 CGPA

For the big services recruiters, the baseline academic filter is remarkably consistent: a minimum of 60% or 6.0 CGPA (candidate-reported for most drives) across Class 10, Class 12 and the degree, with zero active backlogs at application or joining. Two exceptions matter:

Cognizant GenC Next requires 70% — and explicitly does not allow rounding. The official campus brochure states 69.9% is not 70%. Cognizant's system rejects at the eligibility stage before any human sees the profile. GenC and GenC Pro use the 60% floor.

Some Accenture drives ask for 65% / 7.25 CGPA. Off-campus and premium-track Accenture drives have published higher bars. Read each drive's own notice; the 60% baseline applies to most on-campus drives.

Rule	Typical requirement (2026-27)	Notes
Academic floor	60% / 6.0 CGPA in 10th, 12th, degree	Cognizant GenC Next: 70%, no rounding. Some Accenture drives: 65%+
Active backlogs	Zero at application and joining	Cleared (past) backlogs are usually acceptable — drive notice decides
Education gap	Usually up to 1 year (must be explainable)	Wipro has accepted up to 3 years total in some cycles — verify per drive
Cool-off: Accenture	Cannot have appeared for Accenture hiring in last 3 months	
Cool-off: Infosys	Generally cannot re-apply within 6 months of a previous attempt	Some Systems Engineer cycles excepted — check the current listing
Nationality	Indian nationals; OCI/PIO for some drives (Accenture)	

Sources: official Cognizant 2026 campus brochure, Accenture drive notices, and candidate-reported eligibility guides from PapersAdda and FACE Prep, verified September 2026. Always confirm on your own drive notice.

Registration-day traps

The paperwork errors below do not lose you the test — they lose you the candidacy silently, days before it:

Name mismatch. Cognizant requires your name and date of birth to exactly match your 10th marksheet and PAN card. Profiles with discrepancies are disqualified.

The email trap. Cognizant (via Superset) requires a personal email ID that must never change through hiring and onboarding. Use one serious personal ID for the entire season.

One attempt only. Cognizant gives a single attempt per assessment; treat every online test like a final exam, not a mock.

Registration is final. Scores, semester details and documents cannot be edited later at most companies. Fill forms slowly, once.

BUILD THIS FOLDER THIS WEEK

A single cloud folder with: 10th and 12th marksheets, all semester marksheets (or a consolidated transcript), degree/provisional certificate if available, government photo ID and PAN card, passport-size photographs (digital + 6 prints), your final one-page resume (PDF + 6 prints), and every drive registration confirmation email. Interview schedules move fast — one 2026 TCS candidate reported the exam on the 24th, results on the 27th, interview on the 29th. Document chaos on drive day is a self-inflicted wound.

PART 3

The Big Five, Decoded

Five companies hire the bulk of India's engineering freshers. Here is exactly how each one selects.

IN THIS PART

TCS NQT: the one integrated 190-minute test and the Ninja-Digital-Prime ladder

Infosys: InfyTQ sections, the pseudocode trap, and the SE-SP-Power Programmer tracks

Wipro: Elite NTH/NLTH — the only mass test with an essay and, often, spoken English

Accenture: cognitive + pseudocode + communication — and the silent MeritTrac filter

Cognizant GenC: AMCAT, skill clusters, and the ₹2.5 LPA gap between tracks

The Big Five at a glance

Five companies absorb the bulk of India's engineering freshers. Before the company-by-company detail, the single table to keep on your phone all season:

Company	Gateway	Fresher floor	Top fresher band	The filter that's unique to it
TCS	NQT — one integrated 190-min test	Ninja ~₹3.36–3.6 LPA	Prime ~₹9–11.5 LPA	90-min Advanced Coding decides your band
Infosys	InfyTQ assessment (~100 min)	SE ~₹3.6–4.5 LPA	Power Programmer ~₹9.5 LPA	5 pseudocode questions in 10 minutes
Wipro	Elite NTH/NLTH test (~128 min)	Elite ~₹3.5 LPA	Turbo ~₹6.5 LPA	20-min essay + often a spoken-English round
Accenture	~155-min assessment chain	ASE ~₹4.5–6.5 LPA	Advanced ASE ~₹6.5–9 LPA	Automated communication assessment — the silent killer
Cognizant	GenC assessment on AMCAT	GenC ~₹4–4.5 LPA	GenC Next ~₹6.75 LPA+	Skill Cluster: 85% of tech questions from Java + ANSI SQL

Bands are candidate-reported 2026 ranges; the floor is the most common offer, not a guarantee. Verify every figure on your own drive notice and offer letter.

3.1 — TCS: one test, three salary bands

TCS runs a single National Qualifier Test (NQT) for all fresher hiring. There is no separate Ninja exam and no separate Digital exam — one integrated, non-adaptive test sits everyone in the same 190-minute session, and your combined performance maps you to the Ninja, Digital or Prime interview track. The scorecard is valid for two years, and the test is conducted in-centre at TCS iON centres.

Section	Questions	Time	What it tests
Part A — Numerical Ability	20	25 min	Percentages, ratios, time-work, TSD, number system, probability, DI
Part A — Verbal Ability	25	25 min	Reading comprehension, error spotting, sentence completion, email writing
Part A — Reasoning Ability	20	25 min	Seating arrangements, blood relations, syllogisms, series, coding-decoding
Part B — Advanced Quant + Reasoning	~15 (shared)	25 min	Same topics, higher difficulty, multi-step sets
Part B — Advanced Coding	2–3 problems	90 min	Full programs: input handling, arrays, strings, basic DSA, edge cases

TCS NQT 2026 pattern: 83 questions in 190 minutes, one integrated sitting, no negative marking. You cannot return to a sub-section once its timer locks. Advanced is mandatory if you aspire to Digital or Prime.

The three tracks

TCS Ninja (roughly ₹3.36–3.6 LPA) is the default offer for clearing the cutoff; TCS Digital (₹7–7.3 LPA) requires a high integrated score plus a strong Advanced Coding performance; TCS Prime (₹9–11.5 LPA) is the selective top band, usually seen in the stronger college drives. TCS does not publish the score boundaries between bands.

What actually eliminates people

Foundation time management. With ~25 minutes per sub-section, strong candidates report having only 25–30 seconds left per question after reading it. Practise with a hard timer, not a soft one.

The coding environment. First-time users lose minutes just getting comfortable with the TCS compiler. Practise writing complete programs — input parsing included — not just functions.

Neglecting Advanced Coding. It is the single biggest differentiator between a Ninja and a Digital outcome, and it is 90 minutes of the test.

CANDIDATE-INTELLIGENCE — AUGUST 2026 NQT DRIVES

Recent candidates from on-campus NQT drives reported: prioritise coding practice (full programs, input handling, edge cases), then Logical Reasoning, then Verbal and email writing, then Aptitude. In at least one shift, the graph problem was the difference-maker for Digital-track shortlists. Question difficulty varies by shift — your preparation is the only controllable variable.

3.2 — Infosys: InfyTQ and the pseudocode trap

Infosys hires freshers through the InfyTQ ecosystem, the HackWithInfy contest, and campus tie-ups. The standard online assessment runs about 100 minutes with five sections and no negative marking — but sectional cutoffs apply, so one weak section can sink an otherwise good total.

Section	Questions	Time	Notes
Logical Reasoning	15	25 min	Arrangements, syllogisms, coding-decoding, series
Mathematical Ability	10	35 min	Fewest questions, most time per question — arithmetic, probability, DI
Verbal Ability	20	20 min	The fastest-paced section: RC, grammar, vocabulary
Pseudocode	5	10 min	Output prediction and logic tracing — the most underestimated section
Puzzle Solving	4	10 min	Grid puzzles, pattern recognition

Candidate-reported 2026 InfyTQ pattern (PapersAdda, aggregated candidate reports). Some 2026 cycles report a longer variant adding an English-writing section and 2 coding problems in ~45 minutes — prepare all of it; your invite email states the exact sections.

The three tracks

System Engineer (SE, ~₹3.6–4.5 LPA) is the volume track: aptitude test plus a fundamentals interview. Digital Specialist Engineer / Specialist Programmer (~₹6.25–6.5 LPA) requires a strong coding performance in the same test — you do not reapply for a higher track later. Power

Programmer (~₹9.5 LPA) is reached mainly through HackWithInfy and top InfyTQ performance. InfyTQ certification is explicitly preferred for the SP shortlist. Infosys onboarded about 20,000 freshers in FY26 and has publicly targeted a similar FY27 intake.

What actually eliminates people

The 5-in-10 pseudocode section. Ten minutes to trace five blocks of code by hand. Candidates who have never dry-run pseudocode on paper run out of time on the last two questions. Twenty minutes of deliberate tracing practice beats two hours of generic aptitude for this section.

A blank or weak coding section. Coding score is what routes you to SP/DSE during the same sitting. Good aptitude plus an empty coding editor equals SE — only.

The 6-month cool-off. If you appeared in an Infosys process recently, check whether you are even eligible to re-register before you spend weeks preparing.

3.3 — Wipro: Elite NTH/NLTH — essay included

Wipro's fresher gateway (Elite NTH / NLTH — the names refer to the same family of drives) is the only one of the Big Five that asks you to write an essay inside the assessment, and in 2026 cycles several drives added an automated spoken-English round on top. The full test runs roughly 128 minutes:

Section	Format	Time	Notes
Aptitude (quant + logical + verbal)	~36 questions	~48 min	Independently timed; roughly 12 per area; extremely time-pressured
Written Communication	1 essay	20 min	General topics — past drives used AI and employment, social media, online education, climate, digital payments
Coding	2 problems	60 min	C, C++, Java or Python; typically one easy (strings/arrays) + one medium; one full solve usually clears the cutoff

Pattern per FACE Prep (Aug 2026) and FreshersHunt (Sep 2026), candidate-reported. Some drives run a shorter format without coding. Your official invite states the exact sections.

The two tracks

Elite NTH (Project Engineer, ~₹3.5 LPA CTC, in-hand roughly ₹20–25K/month) is the standard offer. Turbo (~₹6.5 LPA) is the higher bar — higher coding cutoffs and typically a 65%+ academic requirement — for the same drive. A 12-month service agreement is standard in recent cycles. Wipro's FY26 fresher intake guidance was revised down to 7,500–8,000, so the remaining seats are contested harder than before: the 60% floor is a floor, not a differentiator.

What actually eliminates people

Aptitude pacing. The aptitude block is designed to feel impossible if you are slow — roughly a minute or less per question. Speed is trained, not hoped for.

Essay quality. Grammar and structure are machine-scored more than creativity. Practise 200-word, four-paragraph essays before the drive.

Spoken English round. Where it appears, it is an automated listen-and-speak assessment. Practise a 2-minute self-introduction out loud until it is smooth — it doubles as your interview opener.

3.4 — Accenture: the communication filter

Accenture's assessment chain is the longest of the five and the only one where a communication round sits inside the online stage itself. No negative marking; the whole online phase runs roughly 155 minutes:

Stage	Format	Time	Notes
Cognitive Assessment	50 questions	50 min	English, critical thinking and problem solving — closer to GRE-style reasoning than CAT-style maths
Technical Assessment	~40 questions	~40 min	Pseudocode, computer fundamentals, networking/cloud basics, MS Office
Coding Round	2 problems	45 min	Any language; passing both strongly is the route to Advanced ASE evaluation
Communication Assessment	Automated spoken English	~20 min	Listening, repeating sentences, short answers — machine-scored fluency and pronunciation

Candidate-reported 2026 pattern (PapersAdda, May–July 2026), consistent with candidate experiences on GeeksforGeeks. A mock/practice link is usually sent before the real test — do not skip it.

The two tracks

Associate Software Engineer (ASE, ~₹4.5–6.5 LPA) is the standard fresher role; Advanced ASE (grade 11A, ~₹6.5–9 LPA) is decided largely by coding performance — Accenture does not always announce which track it is evaluating you for, and the split usually becomes clear at the coding stage. A 12–15 month service agreement is standard.

What actually eliminates people

Treating the communication round as a formality. In recent cycles, candidates with strong cognitive and technical scores were rejected at this stage. The 2026 fluency threshold is reported stricter than the December 2025 cycle. Four to six weeks of reading and speaking aloud daily actually moves this score; one week does not.

Under-preparing pseudocode. Accenture writes its own pseudocode dialect — trace loops, recursion and array traversal on paper until it is automatic.

Ignoring MS Office questions. Excel formulas and Word logic appear in the technical assessment; most engineering students never revise them.

3.5 — Cognizant GenC: the skill-cluster system

Cognizant's GenC program is on track to be the single largest fresher hiring engine in Indian IT this cycle (a reported ~25,000 graduates targeted for FY26-27). Assessments run on AMCAT. Attendance at every section is mandatory, and each assessment gives you one attempt only.

Stage	Format	Time	Notes
Communication Assessment	Spoken + written English	Part of the ~120-min online session	SVAR-style: pronunciation, fluency, grammar — heavily eliminative
Aptitude	16 questions	25 min	Quantitative + logical + data interpretation

Stage	Format	Time	Notes
Verbal	25 questions	25 min	RC, sentence completion, grammar — largest section
Reasoning	16 questions	25 min	Verbal reasoning, critical thinking, patterns
Coding (GenC Pro / Next)	2 problems	45 min	Medium DSA — the lever that moves you up-track

Per the official Cognizant 2026 campus brochure and candidate reports (Aug-Sep 2026). All candidates are initially evaluated for GenC; stronger coding/assessment performance routes you to Pro or Next.

The four tracks

GenC (Programmer Analyst Trainee, ~₹4–4.5 LPA), GenC Elevate (~₹4.5–5.4 LPA), GenC Pro (~₹5.4–6.75 LPA) and GenC Next (~₹6.75 LPA and above, some drives report up to ₹9.5) — the GenC-to-Next gap is ₹2.5 LPA or more for the same company. GenC Next requires 70% academics (no rounding). Skill Cluster 1 is the default technical assessment: Java, ANSI SQL, HTML, CSS and JavaScript — about 85% of its questions come from Java and ANSI SQL alone. If you can comfortably solve array, string and sorting problems, register for the higher track.

What actually eliminates people

The communication assessment. It is the first stage, it is machine-scored, and it is where Tier-2/3 candidates fail most. A quiet room, a wired headset and a steady pace measurably change the outcome.

Skiping a section. All assessments are mandatory to attend — leaving one blank disqualifies the attempt entirely.

Hedging on relocation. The official requirement is willingness to work from any Cognizant office in any shift. Hedging in the interview is a known rejection pattern — decide your honest answer before the interview, not during it.

PART 4

The Aptitude Engine

Aptitude is not intelligence. It is familiarity and speed — both trainable.

IN THIS PART

The high-frequency topic list — what actually appears in drives

The daily 45-minute system that beats weekend cramming

Speed technique: the 90-second question discipline

Pseudocode: the section that separates prepared candidates from lucky ones

What actually appears

Placement aptitude is 10th-standard maths applied under time pressure. Topic frequency is remarkably stable across companies, which is why a single preparation loop covers TCS, Infosys, Wipro, Accenture and Cognizant at once:

Topic	Avg. questions per paper	Appeared in % of drives	Priority
Time, Speed & Distance	3-5	91%	Do first
Time & Work	2-4	88%	Do first
Percentages & Profit/Loss	2-3	85%	Do first
Number Series	2-4	82%	Do first
Blood Relations	2-3	79%	Fast wins
Direction Sense	1-3	76%	Fast wins
Permutation & Combination	2-3	70%	Hardest — cap your time
Data Interpretation	3-5	68%	Hardest — cap your time
Coding-Decoding	2-3	65%	Fast wins
Syllogisms	1-3	60%	Fast wins

Frequency data: PapersAdda analysis of verified 2023–2025 campus placement papers.

The daily 45-minute system

Consistency beats intensity, and volume beats brilliance. The candidates who clear aptitude cutoffs are almost always the ones who solved 500+ questions over months rather than 50 in the final week. Here is the minimum viable daily loop:

Minutes 0-25 — timed mixed set. 30 questions from quant, logical and verbal, with a hard timer. You are training the clock as much as the content.

Minutes 25-35 — error review. Every wrong answer gets one line in a notebook: topic and the mistake type. Revisit the weak topics within 48 hours.

Minutes 35-45 — one weak topic. Rotating. P&C on Monday, DI on Tuesday, and so on until the notebook says otherwise.

Targets that matter. 80%+ accuracy before you chase speed; then drive average time per question under 60–75 seconds. Placement tests allow roughly 60–120 seconds per aptitude question — solving correctly but slowly does not clear cutoffs.

Free sources that are enough. IndiaBix for topic-wise volume, then company-specific papers (TCS NQT, Infosys InfyTQ, Wipro) in the final fortnight. Do not buy a course for this — the free material is genuinely sufficient.

Six patterns that solve half the paper

Most placement questions are archetypes with a standard move. Drill these six until they are reflexes:

Percentages as fractions. Memorise $1/6 = 16.67\%$, $1/8 = 12.5\%$, $1/12 = 8.33\%$, $3/8 = 37.5\%$. A question asking 37.5% of 480 becomes 3×60 in your head. Most profit-loss and interest questions collapse into fraction arithmetic once you do this.

Time & work by units. Stop solving for rates in hours. Assume the total work is the LCM of the given days: A does a job in 12 days, B in 18 — take work = 36 units, so A = 3/day, B = 2/day, together 5/day $\rightarrow 36/5 = 7.2$ days. Works on every question in the topic.

Number series: check in order. Differences first, then ratios, then alternating series (two interleaved sequences). 80% of series questions fall to the first check; write the differences under the series rather than staring at it.

Blood relations: draw, don't read. A quick tree with + for males, – for females, horizontal lines for siblings and arrows for children solves in seconds what re-reading solves in minutes. Same for direction-sense questions — always sketch the walk.

Syllogisms by Venn. Draw the two circles for the standard cases and test each conclusion against them. The trap answers are the ones that are 'probably true' — only what must hold on every valid Venn counts.

Data interpretation: approximate first. Round before you multiply: 48.3% of 2,140 is $\approx$ half of $\sim 2,100 \approx 1,050$ — then check which answer option survives. Options are usually spaced far enough apart that clean approximation beats exact arithmetic.

The day-shape that fits a student's life

The sprint is not about heroic 10-hour days — it is about a repeatable block that survives classes, labs and semester exams:

Block	Time	What it is
Aptitude loop	45 min	Timed set + error review + one weak topic (Part 4)
Coding volume	45–60 min	Two problems, full programs with input handling, one language
Core CS / pseudocode	20 min	One area per day from the Part 6 table, or 10 min paper tracing
Spoken reps	10 min	Record the intro, one HR answer, or one project story; play back at 1.5x

Under 2.5 focused hours a day. Done daily for 30 days it outperforms every weekend-warrior plan.

THE PSEUDOCODE MINIMUM

Infosys gives you five pseudocode questions in ten minutes. Accenture's technical assessment is built around its own pseudocode dialect. Ten minutes a day of dry-running code on paper — trace loops, recursion and array updates by hand, no compiler — covers the most underestimated section in Indian placement testing.

PART 5

The Fresher Resume

One page. Built once, in week one. Reused by every application this season.

IN THIS PART

The structure that survives both ATS software and human interviewers

Project lines that hold up under follow-up questions

The mistakes that get resumes set aside in seconds

Why you should build it now, not the night before the first registration

The structure

For freshers, one page is not a style preference — it is what gets read. Automated ATS screens parse the file before any human does, so keep formatting boringly clean: no tables, no text boxes, no columns, no photos. A single-column PDF, standard font, and this order:

Header. Name, phone, email, city, GitHub/LinkedIn links. Nothing else — no father's name, no marital status, no full address.

Education. Degree, college, expected graduation year, CGPA. 10th and 12th with percentages — companies check these against eligibility anyway.

Projects (2-3). The section that carries fresher interviews. Each project: one line of what it does, the tech stack, and one measurable outcome or concrete detail.

Skills. Only what you can defend in an interview, grouped: languages, frameworks, tools. An honest 'working knowledge' beats an inflated 'expert'.

Anything real. Internships, hackathons, certifications (InfyTQ is a genuine signal for Infosys tracks), open-source contributions.

Project lines that survive interviews

Your strongest project will be interrogated line by line: what problem it solves, why you chose the stack, the hardest part, and what you would do differently today. Write each project line so that you can answer all four from memory:

THE PROJECT-LINE FORMULA

Verb + what it does + tech + a number. 'Built a hostel-mess feedback portal used by 400+ students (React, Node.js, MySQL); cut weekly feedback processing from 3 hours to 10 minutes.' A number can be users, rows, requests, hours saved, accuracy on a test set — anything countable and true. Never write a project you cannot rebuild or explain from a blank page.

Claiming a skill you cannot demonstrate. It is the single most common technical-interview rejection: the resume claims Python; the interviewer asks one follow-up.

A generic objective line. 'Seeking a challenging role in a growth-oriented organisation' says nothing. Delete it; the header earns its space.

Building it the night before. Every application this season reuses the same resume. One good build in week one is cheaper than ten rushed edits at midnight.

PART 6

GD, Technical and HR Rounds

Every decisive round is spoken. Silent preparation does not transfer.

IN THIS PART

The GD framework: structure beats volume

The core-CS question bank that covers 80% of technical rounds

Your project story in three lengths

The AI-usage question — now standard — and how to answer it honestly

HR answers that do not sound rehearsed: intro, strengths, relocation

The group discussion

GDs run 8–12 students for 10–20 minutes with an assessor watching. Students who spent months on aptitude walk into GDs having never practised one. What assessors score is structure and listening, not volume:

Initiate only with a framework. If you open, open with structure — 'I see three angles to this: X, Y, Z' — not with a conclusion. The initiator frames; others fill.

Add, reference, build. The strongest mid-discussion move is referencing a previous speaker by their point and extending it. It proves you are listening — the rarest signal in a GD.

Recover loudly. If someone dismantles your point, concede the valid part and pivot: 'That's fair on the cost side — which is exactly why the second angle matters.' Recovery scores higher than never being challenged.

Never fight for airtime. Three precise contributions beat nine interruptions, every time.

The core-CS question bank

Across TCS, Infosys, Wipro, Accenture and Cognizant fresher interviews, the same fundamentals carry the overwhelming majority of technical rounds:

Area	What gets asked	Prepare to this depth
OOP	Encapsulation, inheritance, polymorphism, abstraction — with real-world examples, not textbook definitions	All four pillars, one example each
DBMS	Normalization 1NF→BCNF, primary vs foreign keys, joins, GROUP BY, simple SQL queries	Write 4–5 joins blind; explain BCNF in two sentences
OS	Process vs thread, deadlock and its conditions, scheduling basics	Definitions plus one scenario each
Networks	TCP vs UDP, what DNS does, IP addressing basics	One-liners, confidently
DSA	One live/easy problem: arrays, strings, sorting, hashmaps	10 problems solved out loud, not silently
Your branch's core	For non-CS branches: the equivalent fundamentals of ECE/ME/EEE	Crisp definitions — technical rounds open with fundamentals

Your project story — three lengths

Rehearse your best project at three lengths: 30 seconds (what and why), 2 minutes (what, why, stack, one hard problem and how you solved it), 5 minutes (the full narrative including what you would change). Interviewers choose the length; you should not have to compose it live.

The AI-usage question

Interviewers in the current cycle explicitly ask how you use AI tools in your work. This is a screening question, not a trap — have a true, specific answer ready: what you use AI for (drafting, debugging hints, learning a concept faster), and where you draw the line (you verify, you understand every line you submit, you can rebuild it without assistance). A candidate who can explain their AI usage deliberately is read as a candidate who will use company tooling responsibly.

HR answers that do not sound rehearsed

A WORKED 'TELL ME ABOUT YOURSELF' (90 SECONDS)

"I'm a final-year computer science student at [College]. I've spent the last two years building around data — my final-year project is a mess-feedback portal used by about 400 students, which is where I learned to handle real users complaining about things I broke. Before that I interned with a small local firm where I automated their weekly reporting and cut it from three hours to ten minutes. I'm here because this role is the natural next step — backend work at scale, with training that actually teaches it." — Present, past, future, one number, stop. Write yours, then say it twenty times.

A WORKED STAR ANSWER (ONE MINUTE)

Question: 'Tell me about a time you handled a failure.' — Situation: our hackathon demo crashed an hour before judging. Task: as team lead I had five minutes to decide what we show instead. Action: I cut to the two slides that worked, demoed the offline fallback, and told the judges exactly what had broken and why. Result: we didn't win, but two judges stayed back to ask how the fallback was built — and the post-mortem we wrote became the team's pre-demo checklist. End on the result and the lesson, then stop.

'Tell me about yourself' — 90 seconds, three beats. Present (degree, one strength, one interest), past (the project or internship that proves the strength), future (why this role is the natural next step). Then stop talking.

Strengths and weaknesses. One real strength with a one-line proof. One real weakness with the fix already in progress — 'I over-engineer small tasks, so I now timebox first versions' beats 'I work too hard' every time.

'Why this company?' One specific, checkable fact — a technology, a recent project, the training programme — beats generic praise. You researched them or you didn't.

Relocation and shifts. For the Big Five, pan-India mobility is usually a hard requirement. Decide your honest position before the interview; hedging is a known rejection pattern, and lying is worse.

Use STAR for behavioural questions. Situation, Task, Action, Result — one minute total, ending on the result.

THE PRACTICE LOOP THAT WORKS

Record your answers on your phone. Play them back at 1.5x. You will hear every filler word, rushed pace and dead-end answer immediately. Two weeks of this does what two months of silent reading cannot — because every decisive round in this process is spoken.

PART 7

Decode the Offer Letter

A ₹3.5 LPA CTC is not ₹29,000 a month. Here is the honest math.

IN THIS PART

CTC vs in-hand: what actually lands in your bank account

The anatomy of a fresher CTC, line by line

Variable pay, service agreements and bonds — read before you sign

How to compare two offers without fooling yourself

CTC is not salary

CTC — cost to company — includes everything the company spends on you: basic pay, allowances, the employer's PF contribution, insurance, gratuity provision, and often a performance-linked variable. Your in-hand is what remains after deductions and after the variable is actually paid out. For mass-track freshers, in-hand typically lands around 60–70% of the monthly CTC figure:

Offer (CTC)	Typical monthly in-hand	Reality check
TCS Ninja — ₹3.36–3.6 LPA	₹22,000–25,000	The most common first offer in Indian IT
Wipro Elite NTH — ₹3.5 LPA	₹20,000–22,500	Fixed base ~₹3.15 LPA + ~₹35K/yr variable
Infosys SE — ₹3.6–4.5 LPA	₹22,000–32,000	Includes employer PF and insurance inside the CTC
Accenture ASE — ₹4.5–6.5 LPA	₹30,000–45,000	Advanced ASE (11A): ₹6.5–9 LPA
TCS Digital — ₹7–7.3 LPA	₹47,000–51,000	Roughly double the Ninja track for the same test
Wipro Turbo / Infosys SP — ₹6.5 LPA	₹37,000–45,000	The higher coding bars cash out here

In-hand figures are candidate-reported ranges (2024–2026 offers via PapersAdda, FACE Prep, OphyAI) and vary with city, tax regime and PF settings. Your offer letter is the only authoritative number.

Anatomy of a fresher CTC

Using a published ₹3.6 LPA Infosys SE structure as the template: basic pay ₹1.8 lakh, HRA ₹72,000, special allowance ₹48,000, employer PF ₹21,600, insurance and benefits ₹38,400. Notice that the last two lines are money the company spends — not money you receive. That is the whole gap between '₹30,000 a month on paper' and '₹23,000 in the bank'.

Variable pay

Most services offers include a quarterly, performance-linked component — on Wipro's mass track, roughly ₹35,000–40,000 per year at target. Treat it as a bonus when it arrives, not as salary when you budget.

Service agreements and bonds

Accenture's standard agreement runs 12–15 months; Wipro's recent cycles used 12 months. Read three things before signing any: the duration, the penalty for leaving early, and whether training costs are recoverable. A bond is not automatically bad — but it should be a decision, not a surprise.

After the offer: the part nobody warns you about

Getting the offer is not the end of the story. Mass recruiters run a joining pipeline that can stretch from a few weeks to several quarters, and what you do in that window matters:

Training is itself an exam. Wipro's freshers go through a multi-month Talent Transformation programme with weekly assessments and a final qualifying exam; clearing it

at the required threshold is mandatory for project allocation. Treat training like semester one of a harder degree, not like a holiday before the job.

Deferral is real. When intake slows, joining dates get pushed. Keep your skills warm, your InfyTQ/NQT scorecards current (the NQT score is valid two years), and your documents folder ready — onboarding verification moves fast when it finally moves.

Do not stop applying. A single offer with a distant joining date is hope, not certainty. Off-campus windows, pool drives and the NQT job portal stay open all year.

COMPARING TWO OFFERS HONESTLY

Compare fixed base, not CTC headlines. Then compare: (1) the track — a Digital/SP/Turbo band compounds faster than a mass band; (2) the training programme — mass recruiters' training quality varies more than their salaries; (3) location and cost of living; (4) the bond terms. A ₹4 LPA offer with no bond and a strong training programme is often the better first job than a ₹5 LPA offer with a two-year lock-in.

PART 8

The 30-Day Sprint Plan

For the student whose first company arrives next month.

IN THIS PART

Week 1: eligibility audit, resume v1, and the daily aptitude habit

Week 2: your target companies' actual patterns + pseudocode + coding volume

Week 3: core CS revision, the project story, full-length mocks

Week 4: everything out loud — mocks, GD practice, documents, drive-day protocol

Week 1 — foundations (days 1-7)

Do the things that every subsequent week depends on:

Day 1: eligibility audit. Pull out 10th, 12th and semester marks. Check every target company's floor against them honestly, including the no-rounding rules. List the 8-10 realistic target companies from your college's expected list.

Day 2-3: resume v1. One page, single column, the Part 5 structure. Send it to one senior or mentor for a hard review; incorporate; freeze v2.

Day 3-7 and every day after: the 45-minute aptitude loop. 30 timed mixed questions, error review, one weak topic. This never stops until you are placed.

Day 5: documents folder. The Part 2 checklist, complete, in the cloud and on your phone.

Week 2 — company-specific depth (days 8-14)

Now convert the Part 3 patterns into targeted practice for your top three targets:

Two timed coding problems daily. Arrays, strings, hashmaps, sorting, basic recursion — the level mass-recruiter tests actually ask. Full programs with input handling, in one language, in a plain editor.

Ten minutes of daily pseudocode tracing. Paper only. This is the Infosys and Accenture differentiator.

Company pattern drill. Take one full company-specific mock (TCS NQT pattern, Infosys pattern, Wipro pattern — free sets exist on IndiaBix and PrepInsta-class portals) and analyse it the same evening.

Verbal basics if your English is weak. Read one editorial aloud daily; it feeds the verbal sections, the Wipro essay and the communication rounds simultaneously.

Week 3 — core and consolidation (days 15-21)

OOP with real examples, DBMS joins and normalization, OS process-vs-thread, the TCP/UDP one-liners — the Part 6 table, one area per day. Build your project story in its three lengths. Take one full-length mock under real conditions: no breaks, no hints, timer running, and afterwards track three numbers — accuracy, average time per question, and the weak-topic list.

Week 4 — out loud (days 22-30)

The last stretch is spoken, because every decisive round is spoken:

Two mock interviews minimum. A senior, a teacher, or a peer with a hard question list. Record and review.

The 90-second intro, the strengths/weaknesses answers, the relocation answer, the AI-usage answer — rehearsed until they are boring.

Two GD rounds with friends. Score each other only on structure and referencing — not volume.

Logistics the night before any drive: charge the laptop, test the webcam and microphone, print the documents, plan to arrive an hour early.

Drive-day protocol

Before the test: Sleep beats one more chapter. Eat. Carry water. Read the test instructions twice — especially which sections exist and whether navigation back is allowed.

During the test: Attempt everything when there is no negative marking — an unanswered question costs exactly what a wrong one does: zero marks earned. Bank the fast wins first; cap P&C and DI questions at their per-question time.

Between rounds: Interviews are scheduled tightly; documents get verified on the spot. Keep the folder in reach, the phone charged, and eat when you can.

After the PPT: Ask your one prepared question in the pre-placement talk — the ones who ask are the ones who get remembered at registration.

WHAT THIS KIT CANNOT DO

It cannot read your drive notice for you. Patterns shift between cycles, eligibility rules differ by college, and the offer letter in your hand outranks every table in these pages. Verify, then prepare. And do not cheat in the tests — companies re-verify, the cool-off periods are long, and the industry is smaller than it looks.

Sources and verification

Every pattern, band and rule in this kit was verified in September 2026 against: the official TCS iON NQT and TCS careers pages; the official Cognizant 2026 campus hiring brochure; official Accenture drive notices; candidate-reported pattern and salary aggregations from PapersAdda, FACE Prep, FreshersHunt, PlacementPapers.app and OwnYourCareer (2026 editions); and first-person 2026 drive experiences shared on LinkedIn and GeeksforGeeks (July–September 2026). Candidate-reported figures are labelled as such throughout and should be re-confirmed on your own drive notice.

THE CAMPUS PLACEMENT CRASH KIT

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